SettleKnot

Smart Trip Group Expense & Settlement Platform

OFFICIAL USER MANUAL • RELEASE 2026

SettleKnot User Guide

A comprehensive guide to accessing, installing as a mobile app, managing rooms, splitting expenses, and verifying two-step settlements.

APP WEB ADDRESS: `https://settleknot.onrender.com`

PWA Mobile App

1-Click Chrome & Safari home-screen installation. Zero PlayStore hassle.

2-Step Settlements

Payer marks Paid (⏳ Pending). Receiver approves (✓ Paid) to verify.

Realtime Cloud DB

Supabase PostgreSQL permanent cloud synchronization across all devices.

Prepared For: All SettleKnot Travelers, Hosts & Room Members
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Platform URL: settleknot.onrender.com
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Everything you need to master group expense tracking, payment reconciliations, and trip accountability.

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💡 Minimum Cash-Flow Algorithm

SettleKnot calculates the optimal cash flow across the entire room. Instead of everyone paying each other multiple times, debts are minimized into the fewest possible peer-to-peer transfers!

✨ Key Features Highlights

- **Zero PlayStore Download:** Instant Progressive Web App (PWA) with native launcher icon.
- **30-Day Session Persistence:** Stay logged in on mobile without annoying daily logins.
- **Locked Payer Integrity:** Payer is locked to the logged-in user so nobody can log fake expenses under others' names.
- **Anti-Fraud Settlement:** Settlements require confirmation by the recipient before balance is deducted.
- **Creator-Only Deletion:** Only the original payer has the authority to delete their logged expense.
- **PDF Trip Statements:** Export full branded audit reports with timestamped transaction receipts.

🌐 Official Production Web URL

`https://settleknot.onrender.com`

Works seamlessly in Mobile Chrome, Mobile Safari, Firefox, Edge, and Desktop Browsers.

Chapter 1: Welcome to SettleKnot

Managing group expenses on road trips, vacations, and shared apartment stays has historically been frustrating. Traditional split apps allow users to fabricate payments, lack real-time synchronization, or require clumsy app-store installations. SettleKnot solves these challenges with a cutting-edge, mobile-first web application.

Why SettleKnot is Different

SettleKnot was built from the ground up for high-trust trip groups. It incorporates mathematical optimization to reduce the number of peer-to-peer transfers, while offering strict session security and recipient verification.

🛡️ Built-in Integrity & Security Rules

1. Creator-Only Expense Deletion: Only the specific user who paid and logged an expense has permission to delete it. Other members cannot tamper with your logs.

2. Payer Locking: When logging an expense, the payer field is locked directly to your authenticated profile.

3. Receiver-Approved Settlements: When you mark an amount as paid, it stays in `⏳ PENDING` until the receiving friend confirms receipt.

4. Permanent Cloud Database: All data is permanently hosted on Supabase PostgreSQL so your balances are never lost.

🎯 Zero Installation Friction

Users don't need to visit an App Store. Open the link `settleknot.onrender.com`, tap "Install App", and SettleKnot installs directly onto your phone's home screen!

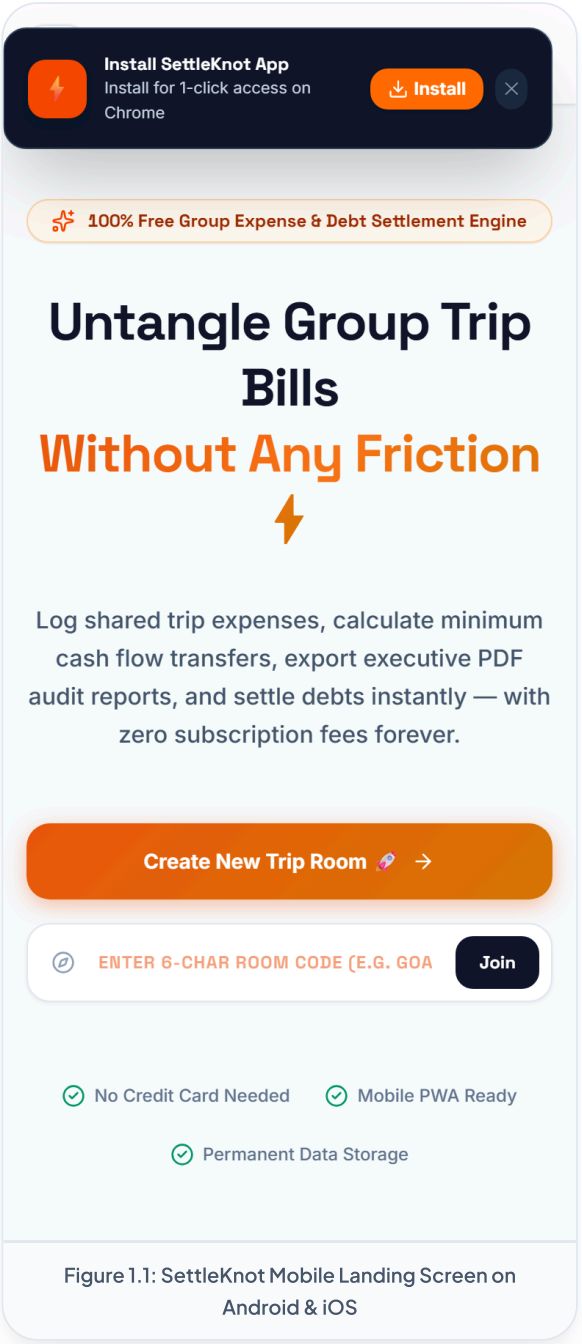


Figure 1.1: SettleKnot Mobile Landing Screen on Android & iOS

Chapter 2: Opening the URL & Installing as an App

SettleKnot is engineered as a **Progressive Web App (PWA)**. It provides all the benefits of a native mobile application (standalone full screen, desktop icon, smooth animations) without taking up megabytes of device storage.

STEP 1: OPEN YOUR BROWSER

Type or Tap the Application URL

`https://settleknot.onrender.com`

🤖 Installing on Android (Google Chrome)

1. **Open URL in Chrome:** Launch Google Chrome on your Android mobile device and navigate to `settleknot.onrender.com`.
2. **Look for the Install Banner:** SettleKnot will automatically display an *"Install SettleKnot App"* prompt at the top right of your screen.
3. **Tap "Install":** Tap the orange **Install** button. Chrome will prompt: *"Add to Home screen?"* Tap **Add** or **Install**.
4. **Manual Alternative:** If the prompt doesn't show automatically, tap the **three dots (⋮)** at the top right corner of Chrome and select **"Install app"** or **"Add to Home screen"**.
5. **Launch from App Drawer:** The SettleKnot icon will now appear on your home screen and app launcher. Tap it to launch full-screen!

> ⚡ **App Experience Advantage**
>
> When launched from your home screen, the browser address bar and navigation controls disappear completely, giving you a full-bleed native app experience!

🍎 Installing on iPhone & iPad (Apple Safari)

1. **Open Safari:** Launch Safari on iOS and visit `settleknot.onrender.com`.
2. **Tap the Share Button:** At the bottom toolbar of Safari, tap the **Share icon** (the square with an arrow pointing upwards ⎋).
3. **Select "Add to Home Screen":** Scroll down the action menu and tap **"Add to Home Screen"** (icon with a plus sign ⊞).
4. **Confirm Name:** Tap **Add** in the top-right corner. The SettleKnot icon will immediately be placed on your iOS desktop.

> 💻 **Desktop (Chrome, Brave, Edge)**
>
> On Windows or Mac, click the **Install App icon (⊕)** located on the right side of Chrome's address bar to install SettleKnot as a standalone desktop window.

Chapter 3: Account Registration & Secure Login

SettleKnot provides individual accounts so your payments, expenses, and rooms are customized to your profile. Setting up an account takes less than 20 seconds.

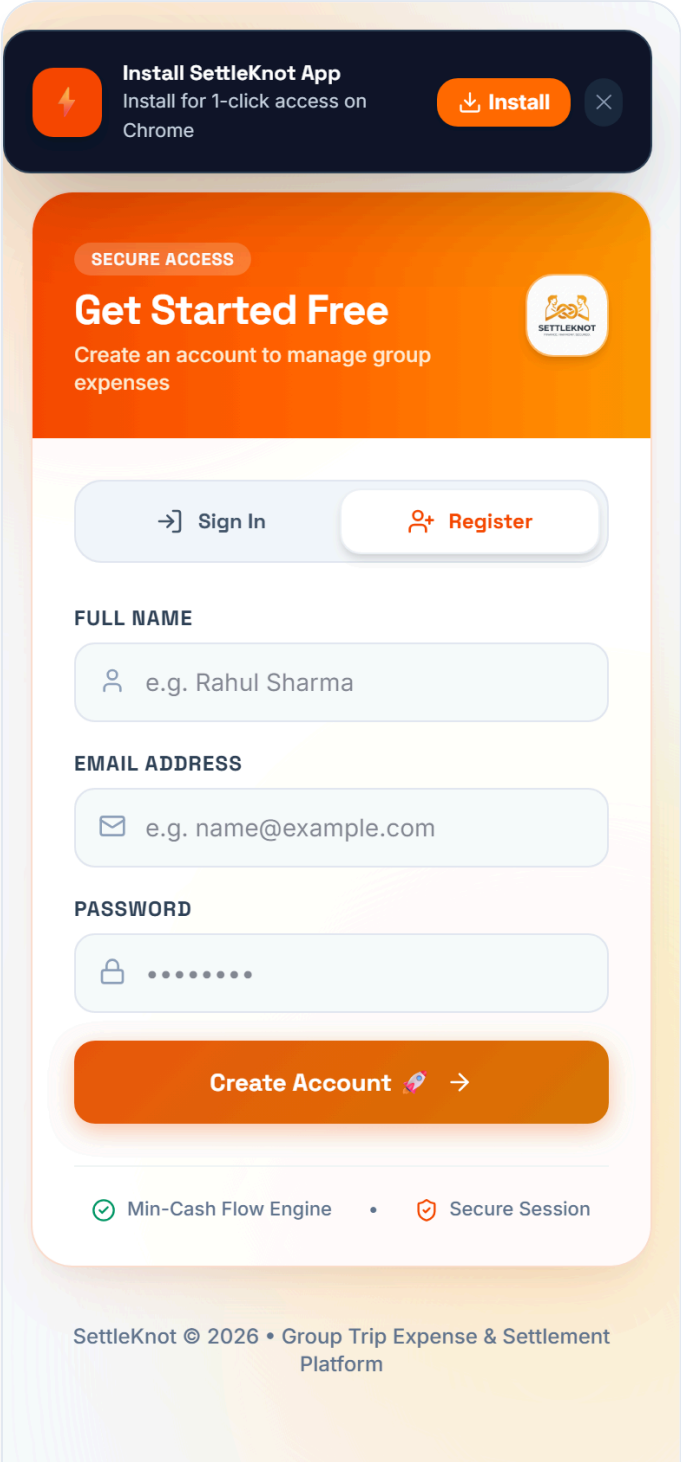


Figure 3.1: Account Registration Form

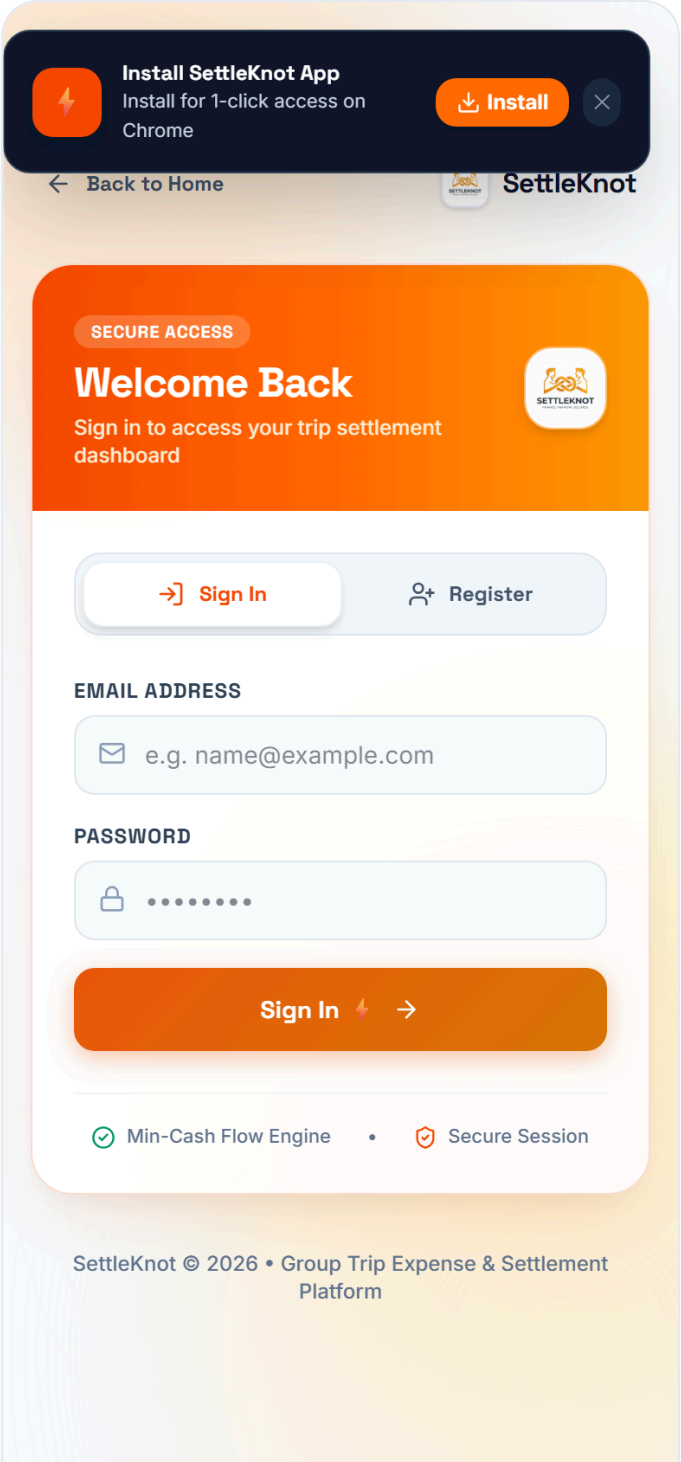


Figure 3.2: Secure Login Form

Step-by-Step Registration:

1. Tap **"Get Started"** or **"Register"** on the landing page.
2. Enter your **Full Name** (e.g., *Alex Johnson*).
3. Enter your **Email Address** (e.g., *alex@example.com*).

Logging In & Session Security:

1. Select the **"Sign In"** tab on the authentication screen.
2. Enter your registered Email Address and Password.
3. Tap **"Sign In "** to access your trips and settlements.

4. Create a secure **Password**.
5. Tap **"Create Account 🚀"**. You will be automatically assigned an animal avatar and redirected to your Dashboard!

> **🔒 30-Day Mobile Persistent Session**
> SettleKnot maintains your session active for 30 days of inactivity on mobile devices. If you log out, SettleKnot's route guard prevents accessing protected data even if someone presses the browser's Back button!

Chapter 4: Dashboard & Trip Room Management

The Dashboard is your mission control. From here, you can create new trip rooms for upcoming holidays, join an existing room with a 6-character code, or view your active trip statistics.

Creating a New Trip Room

If you are the organizer or host of a trip:

1. In the **"Create Trip Room"** card, enter your trip name (e.g., *Goa Reunion* 🏄 or *Manali Trekking*).
2. Choose your preferred currency (defaults to **₹ INR**).
3. Tap **"Create Room ⚡"**. SettleKnot instantly generates a unique **6-character Room Code** (e.g., `GOA26X`).
4. Share the 6-character code or QR Code with your friends via WhatsApp, Telegram, or SMS.

Joining an Existing Trip Room

If your friend already created the room:

1. In the **"Join Trip Room"** card, enter the 6-character code (e.g., `GOA26X`).
2. Tap **"Request to Join 🚀"**.
3. Your join request is immediately sent to the Room Host. Once the host taps **Approve**, you have full access to view debts and log expenses!

> **👥 Host Protection Rule**
> Travelers cannot view or tamper with private room finances until the Host approves their join request. Repeated spam requests (3 rejections) will automatically block unauthorized users.

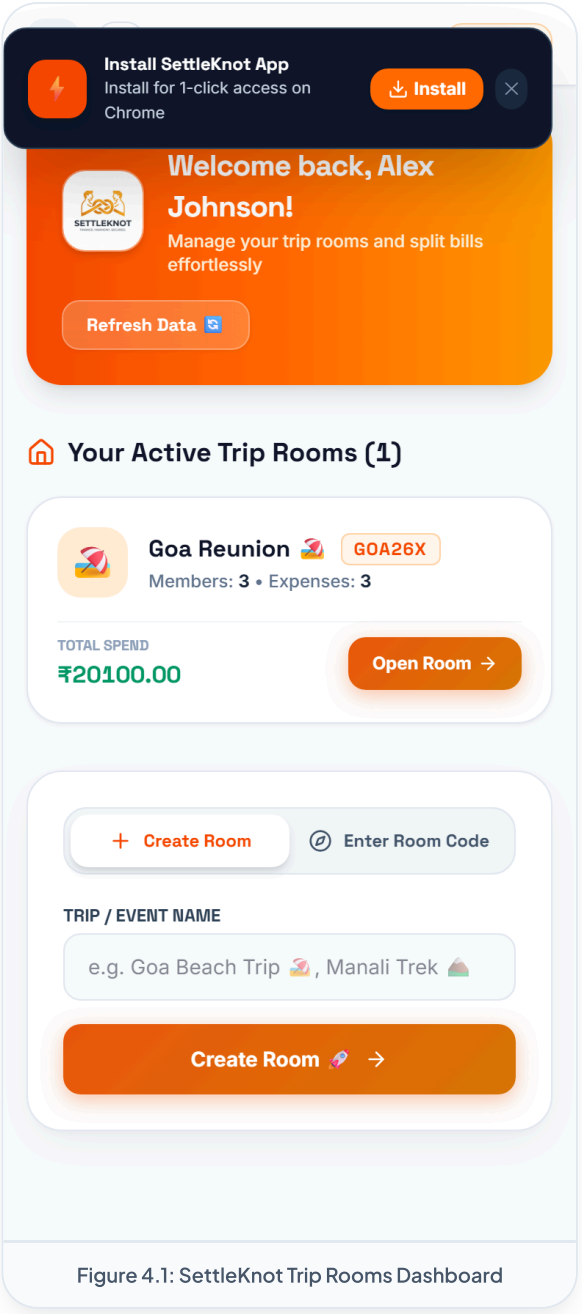


Figure 4.1: SettleKnot Trip Rooms Dashboard

Chapter 5: Logging Expenses & Auto-Split Rules

Whenever someone pays for lunch, fuel, villa rental, or drinks, log it immediately into the room. SettleKnot simplifies this process with automatic member selection and locked payer security.

Step-by-Step Expense Logging

1. Inside the Trip Room, navigate to the **Logged Expenses** tab and tap the orange **"+ Log Expense"** button.
2. **Expense Title:** Enter what was purchased (e.g., *Beach Villa Resort (2 Nights)*).
3. **Amount (₹):** Enter the total cost (e.g., *12,000*).
4. **Category:** Select from Stay 🏨, Food 🍔, Transport 🚕, Activities 🏄, or Misc 🏷️.
5. **Locked Payer:** Notice that the *"Paid By"* field is automatically locked to your user name. You cannot accidentally assign payments to other members.
6. **Split Method:** Choose **"Equal Split"** or **"Custom Split"**. Tapping "Equal Split" automatically includes all approved members with a single tap!
7. **Notes / Tag:** Optionally add payment notes (e.g., *Paid via Google Pay*).
8. Tap **"Log Expense ⚡"**. A celebratory confetti animation will confirm the transaction!

> 🗑️ **Expense Deletion Security**
> Only the specific member who paid and logged the expense has the delete trash icon enabled. If any other member tries to delete it, SettleKnot blocks the action with a permission error.

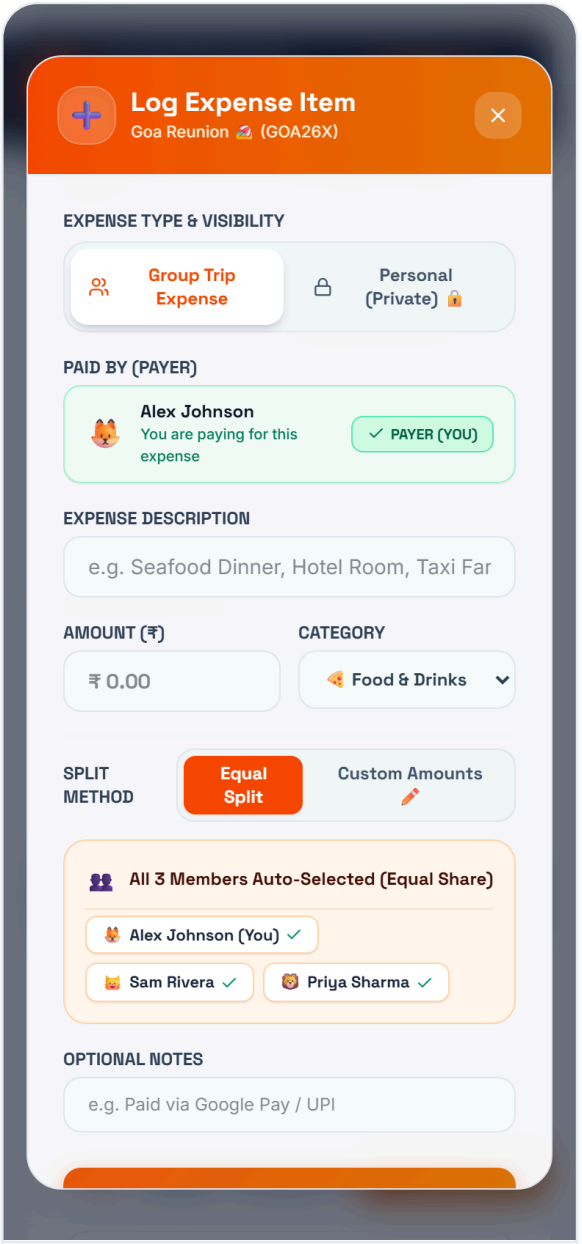


Figure 5.1: Log Expense Modal with Auto Equal-Split

Chapter 6: Two-Step Settlement Verification Workflow

In ordinary split apps, anyone can tap "settle" and falsely erase a debt without actually sending money. SettleKnot introduces a **Two-Step Settlement Verification Workflow** that guarantees both parties agree before a debt is marked clear.

How the 2-Step Workflow Works:

Step 1: Payer Sends Money & Taps "Mark Paid"

After transferring the funds via UPI (GPay/PhonePe), the debtor taps **"Mark Paid"** on the settlement card. The settlement status immediately switches to `⏳ PENDING`. The debt is *not* erased yet, but held in escrow waiting for confirmation.

Step 2: Receiver Verifies Bank & Approves

The person who was owed money gets an alert in their Notification Center and on the Room Settlements tab. After checking their bank account:

- **Tap "Approve ✓":** Status turns to `✓ PAID`, and the balance is permanently settled!
- **Tap "Decline ✕":** If the money was not received, the receiver taps Decline. The status changes to `✕ DECLINED`, and the debtor receives a **"Pay Again"** button.

📱 Mobile-Optimized Action Buttons

All settlement action buttons ("Mark Paid", "Approve ✓", "Decline ✕") are sized and styled with responsive wrapping so they never overflow mobile screens!

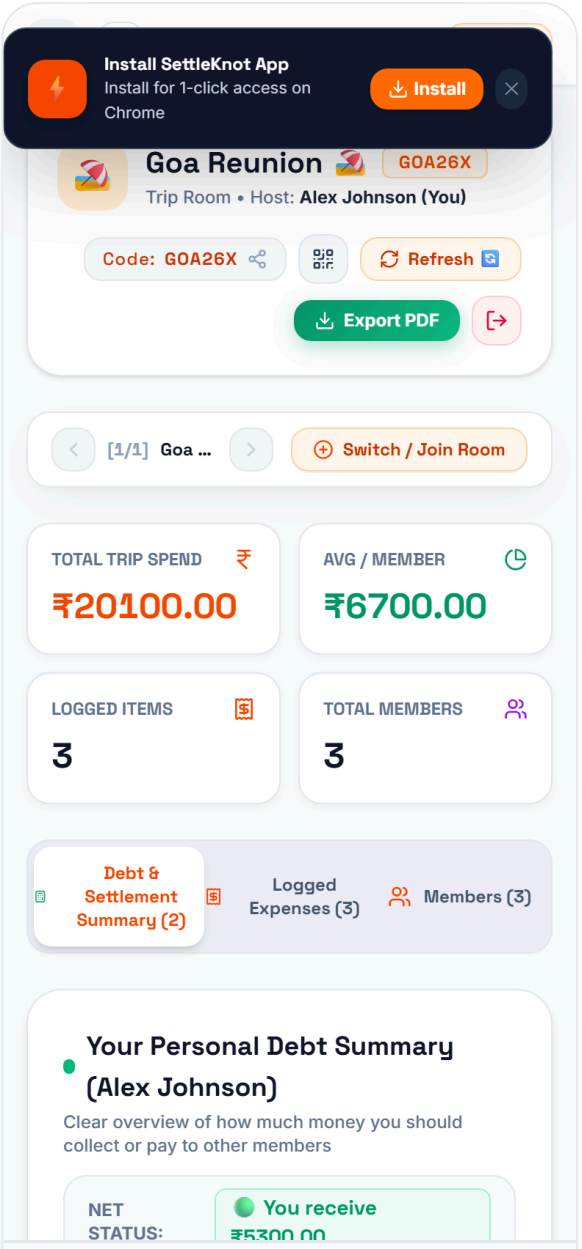


Figure 6.1: Debt Settlements & Verification Statuses

Chapter 7: Notifications & Host Approvals Center

The Notifications screen serves as an inbox for all pending settlement approvals and membership join requests across every room you participate in.

Centralized Action Inbox

You don't need to manually click into individual rooms to check whether someone paid you. Navigate to **Notifications** 🔔 in the sidebar or bottom menu:

📥 Payments Awaiting Your Verification

Displays cards for every friend who marked a payment as paid to you. Each card shows the **Trip Room Name**, the **Sender's Name**, the **Amount (₹)**, and exact timestamp.

Simply tap **Approve** ✓ or **Decline** ✕ directly from this screen.

📤 Payments You Claimed as Paid

Displays payments you sent to others that are currently awaiting the receiver's verification. Shows the pulsing `⏳ PENDING` badge until approved.

⚡ Zero-Action Realtime Synchronization

SettleKnot polls the Supabase Cloud backend every 3 seconds in the background. As soon as your friend approves a payment or joins a room, your screen updates instantly without requiring a manual browser refresh!

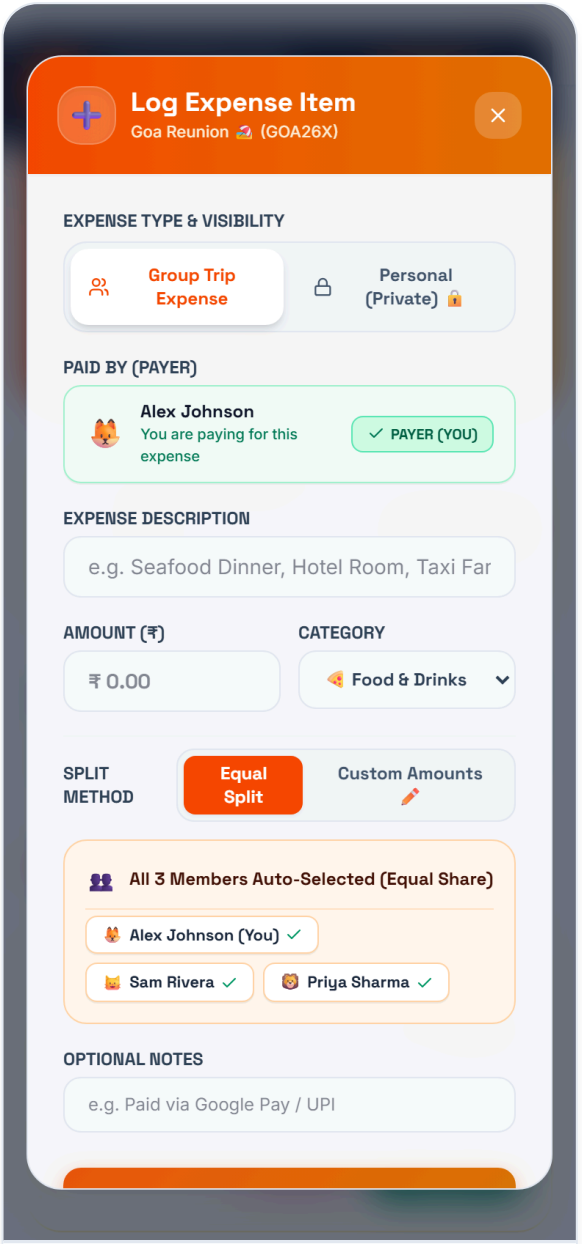


Figure 7.1: Notifications & Payment Approvals Inbox

Chapter 8: PDF Reports, Audit Statements & FAQ

At the end of your trip, you can download a full, professional trip statement PDF for your records, group chats, or accounting.

Generating a Trip PDF Report

1. Open your Trip Room in SettleKnot.
2. At the top header bar, tap the green **"Export PDF"** button.
3. SettleKnot immediately compiles all group expenses, member contributions, net balances, and verified settlement transfers into a beautiful, downloadable PDF!
4. Save the PDF to your phone files or share directly into your WhatsApp group.

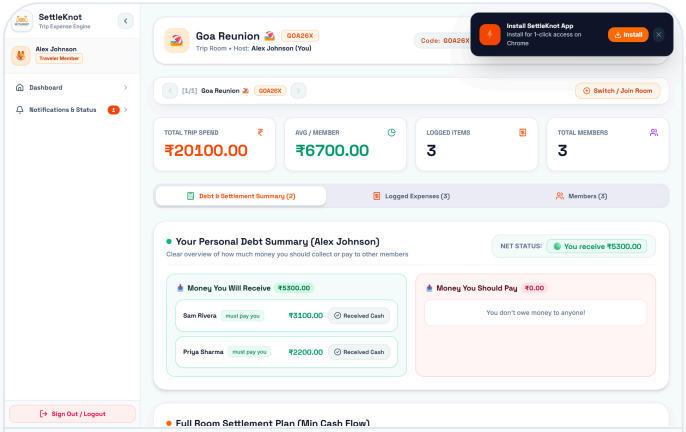


Figure 8.1: Full Desktop and Tablet Dashboard View

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

❓ Do my friends need an account to join?

Yes. Creating an account takes only 15 seconds. Once signed up, they can enter your 6-character room code to request access.

❓ Is our data saved permanently?

Yes! SettleKnot is integrated with Supabase Cloud Database (PostgreSQL). Your trip records, expenses, and payments remain permanently safe.

❓ Can someone delete my expense?

No. SettleKnot strictly enforces creator-only deletion. Only the logged-in user who paid for an expense has the option to delete it.

❓ What happens if a payment is declined?

If the recipient didn't receive the money and taps Decline, the status updates to `✕ DECLINED`. The payer can then tap "Pay Again" to resubmit.

🎉 Start Settling Seamlessly Today!

Bookmark or install SettleKnot on your mobile device now:
`https://settleknot.onrender.com`